

Highlights - Online Business License Application

The Business Licensing Act, 1972 is the law regulating business licenses in Tanzania. There are two categories of business licenses, Category A and Category B.

Category A business licenses are issued by the Ministry of Industry, Trade and Investment, which can be obtained through the Tanzania National Business Portal Application (“the **TNBP**”). On 1st October 2019, the TNBP was introduced as an online system created to speed track business license applications under the mandate of the Business Licensing and Regulatory Agency (**BRELA**). While **Category B** business licenses are obtained from the Municipal Council by making an application and submitting the required documents physically.

The list of business line for both categories are listed in the TFN 211 form and through the website <https://business.go.tz/>.

To access the TNBP, the applicant must have a valid, active email address and phone number to create an account, there after inserting a password to activate the account.

The next step after registration is to login with your username (the applicant’s email address) and password.

In processing a new Business License through the **TNBP**, the applicant must fill the online Application Form (the **Application Form**) by inserting the Company’s information. After filling the application form, the Applicant must scan and upload the following copies;

- Certificate of Incorporation;
- Memorandum and Articles of Association;
- Current Lease with paid Stamp Duty and stamped by TRA or Title deed;
- TIN Certificate;
- Director’s and Shareholder’s IDs or Valid Passports;
- Tax Clearance Certificate;
- Sector Permit for businesses regulated by sector Ministry, Authorities or Agencies from the respective Agencies; and
- Power of Attorney for a Tanzanian representative and their ID in case of a foreign companies or when all the shareholders are foreigners.

Once all the documents are uploaded, the applicant must submit the Application Form for the Business License officer to verify the application and assess the fees. The applicant will then receive a payment order through the TNBP and must proceed to make payments within seven (7) days.

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When the payment is affected, the applicant will receive a new license. The timeframe for receiving a new business license varies from two (2) days to seven (7) working days.

NB: The issued business license is subject to renewal each year on the anniversary of the first issuing date. In the process of renewing the business license, the applicant must upload all the above-mentioned documents and fill in the Application Form afresh. If there is any change in directorship or shareholder, the applicant must upload a recent company search report to determine the same.

I hope this information is helpful, should you have any inquiries do not hesitate to contact our offices.

Prepared By

Linda Natai

Stallion Attorneys

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Always there

 7th Floor Diamond Plaza, Mirambo Street – P.O. Box 5664, Dar es Salaam, Tanzania

[e. ask@stallionattorneys.co.tz](mailto:ask@stallionattorneys.co.tz)

[t. +255 767 937 368](tel:+255767937368)

[w. www.stallionattorneys.co.tz](http://www.stallionattorneys.co.tz)